Lava Ball

a strategically explosive action combination sport for 2

by Playlines Games playlines@proton.me

Videos

How to Play
https://youtu.be/66ej4OFlUtE

Sample Game
https://youtu.be/CtFXlm0g7nE

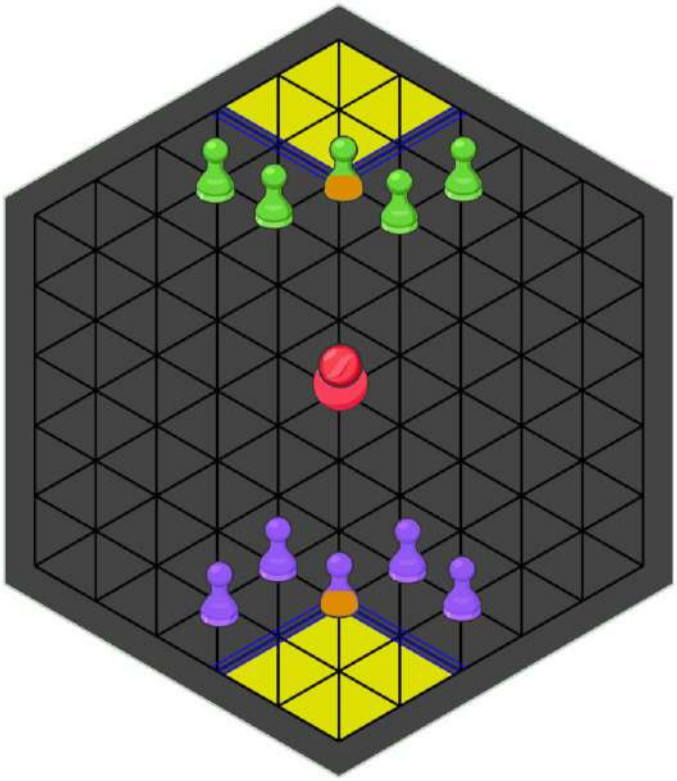
Victory

You win when you score 2 goals.

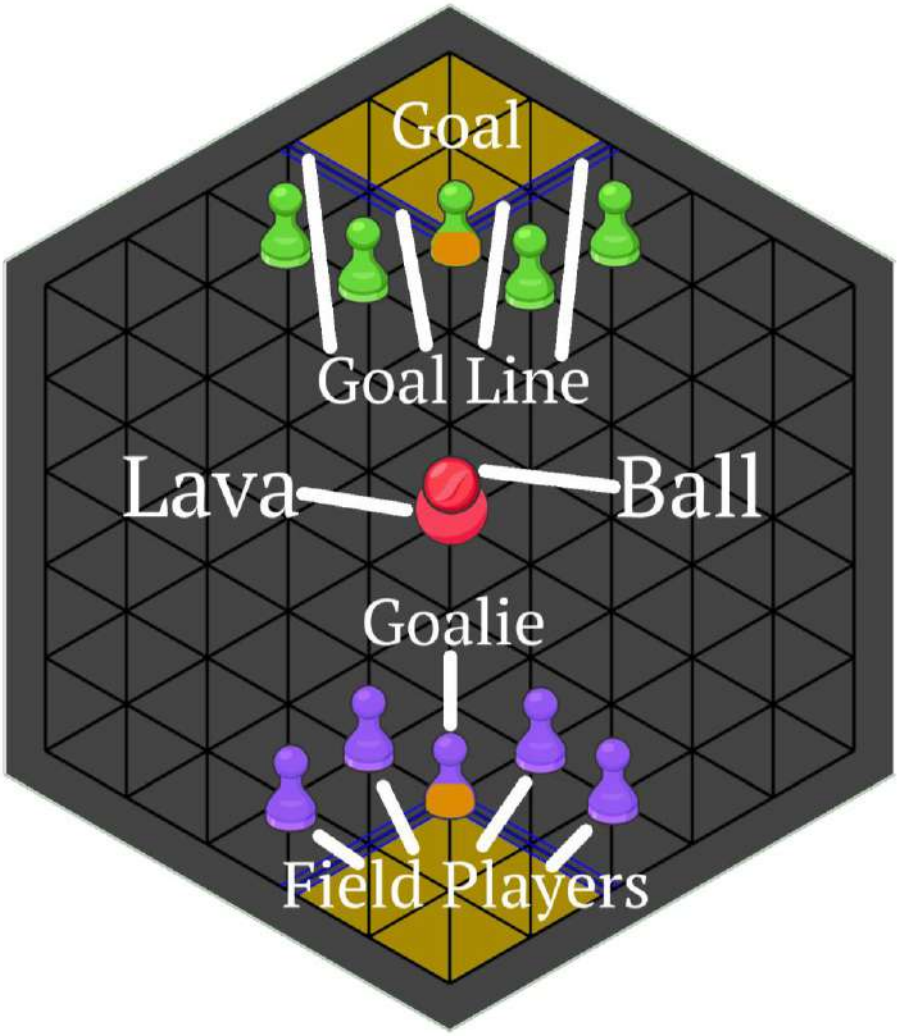
Setup

The Lava Ball starts in the middle on a red Lava. Goalies start on their center Goal Line spot. Field Players start on Field spots near their Goalie, as shown.

Whoever last kicked a ball chooses a team to control and takes a Regular Turn to start.



Components



Players: 4 Field Players, 1 Goalie per team. All of your Players can pivot and kick the Ball in your Possession Phase. Goalies have the disadvantage of being unable to score and the advantage of blocking Ball pivots from opponent Players.

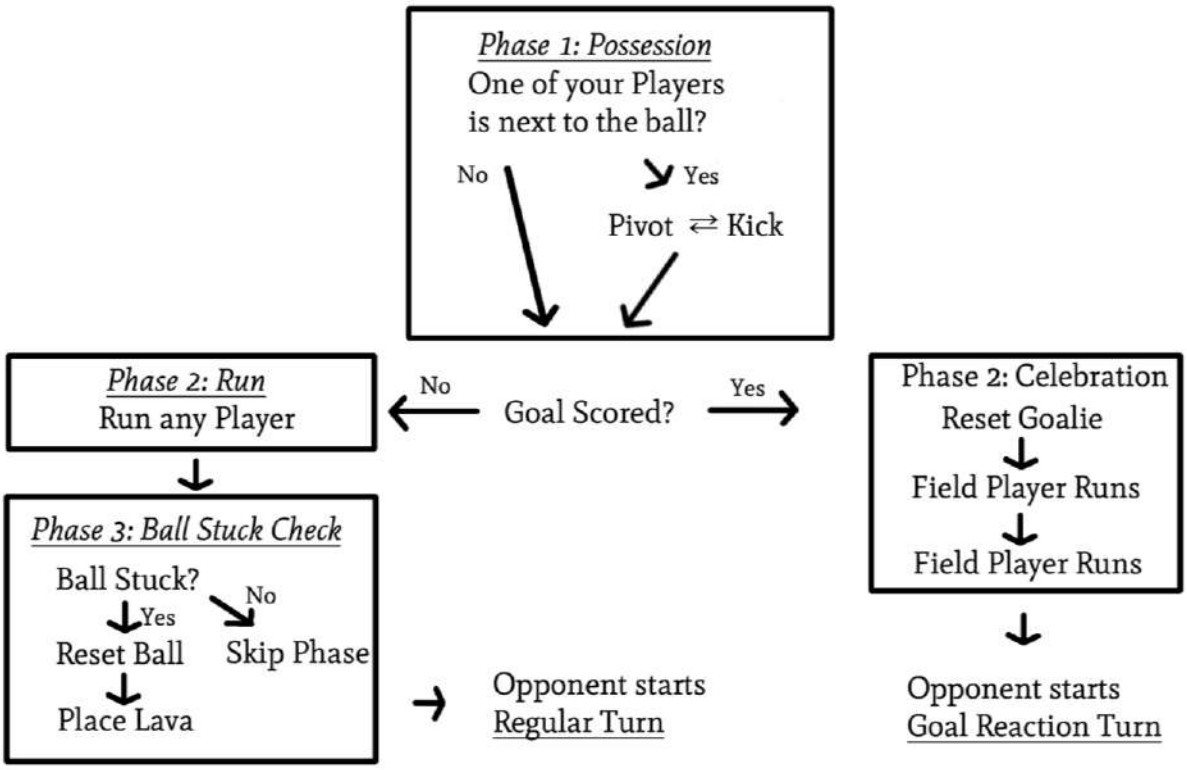
Lava: 1 Lava starts on the center Field spot. Lava blocks running Players. When you score, your opponent places a Lava to an empty Field spot.

Field spot: All spotsin the large area between the two Goal Lines, including along the edge of the board and the center of the board. Field spots can hold 1 Player or the Ball.

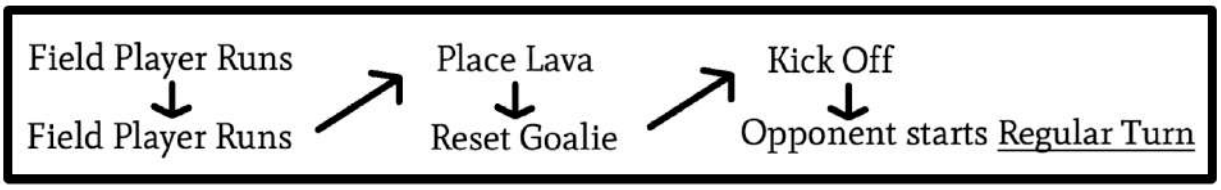
Goal Line: Your Goalie can move within your own Goal and Goal Line spots. None of your Players can move into the Goal Line of your opponent.

Goal: The spots behind the Goal Line. Kick the Ball past your opponent's Goal Line into their Goal to score. You cannot move the Ball into your own Goal.

Regular Turn Flow



Goal Reaction Turn Flow

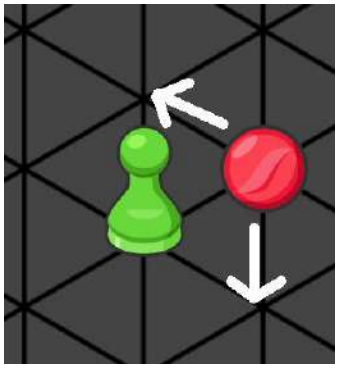


Regular Turn Phase 1: Possession

- If one of your Players is adjacent to the Ball, you have Possession.
    - Without Possession, your turn advances to the Run Phase.
- With Possession, you may take pivot and kick actions with your Players.
- **Take 0 or as many pivot and kick actions as you want.**
    - If you score with a Kick, immediately proceed to your Celebration Phase.
    - If you end your Possession Phase without scoring, proceed to your Run Phase.
    - Pivot
        - With the Ball adjacent to one of your Players, move the Ball 1 spot around your Player.
        - You cannot pivot the Ball off the board. You cannot pivot the Ball to a spot where your opponent's Goalie is.
        - You can pivot the Ball to a spot where a Player is, excluding your opponent's Goalie, but the Ball can't stay there: you must pivot or kick the Ball with any of your Players before ending your Possession Phase.
        - **A Player who pivots cannot pivot again this Possession until another Player on their team pivots or kicks.**
    - Kick
        - With the Ball adjacent to one of your Players, move the Ball away in a straight line at least 1 spot to any spot in that line without a Player.
        - Players, who are on spots other than where the Ball starts the kick action, block the Ball's movement.
        - You cannot kick the Ball off the board.
        - You cannot kick the Ball past your own Goal Line into your own Goal.
        - Kick the Ball past your opponent's Goal Line into their Goal to score.
        - **Your Goalie cannot kick the Ball past your opponent's Goal Line.**

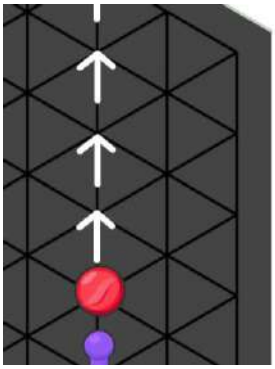
Pivot Example

Possible Pivots. Pivots rotate the Ball one spot around your Player.



Kick Example

Possible Kicks. Kicks move the Ball any distance away from your Player.

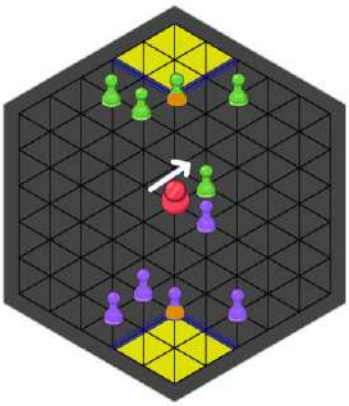


Basic Possession Examples

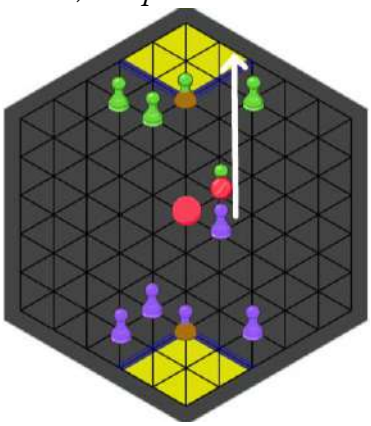
When you start your turn with a Player adjacent to the Ball, you can pivot to move the Ball 1 spot around your Player or kick to move the Ball any number of spots away from your Player.

Green blundered by running next to Purple's Field Player. Field Players do not block pivots. Purple pivots the Ball into the spot where Green's Field Player is and kicks to score.

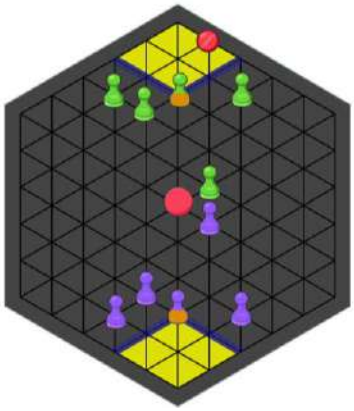
1) Purple pivots.



2) Purple kicks.

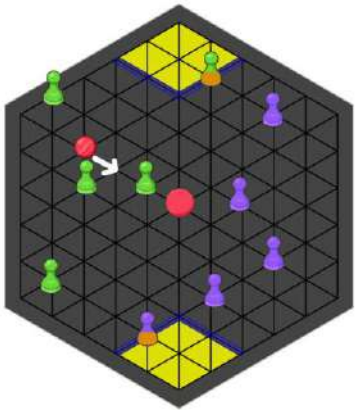


3) Purple scores!

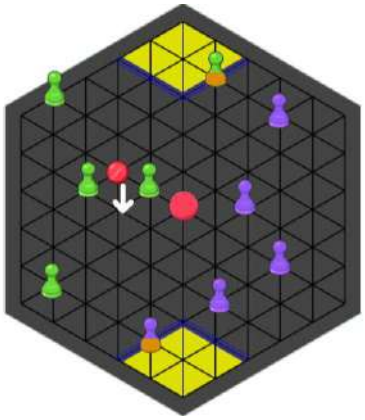


Green conducts a combination to move the Ball closer to Purple's goal.
The same Player cannot pivot twice in a row, so Green alternates Players for pivots.

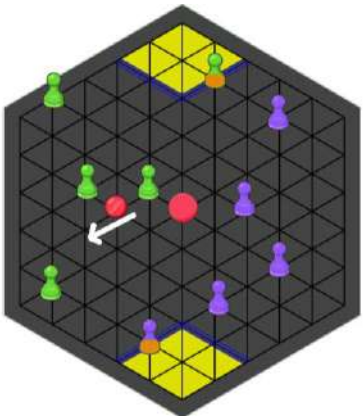
1) Green pivots.



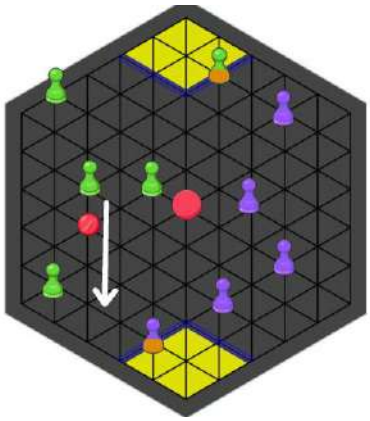
2) Green pivots.



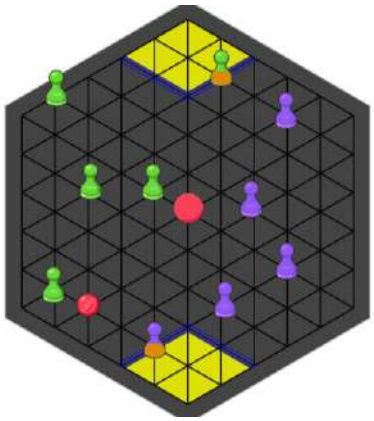
3) Green pivots again with the first Player.



4) Green kicks.



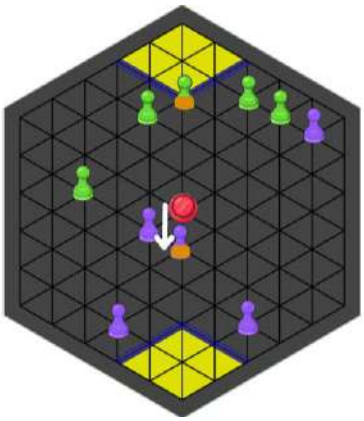
5) Result.



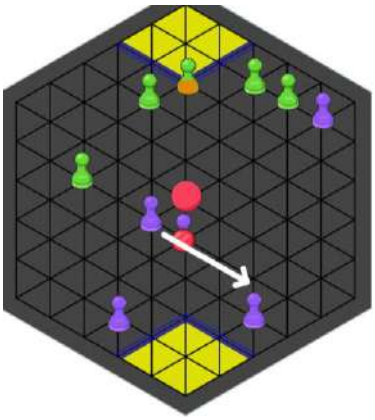
Intermediate Possession Examples

Your Goalie can run into the Field. Your opponent's Goalie is the only Player who blocks pivots. You can pivot through your Goalie. Purple conducts a sequence to reposition the Ball.

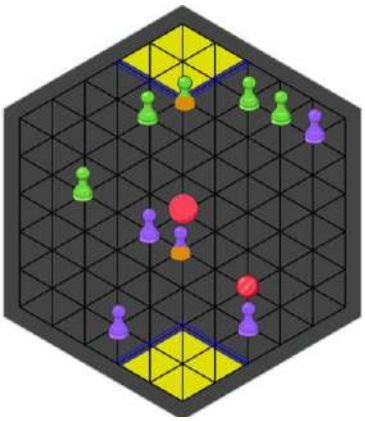
1) Purple pivots into their Goalie.



2) Purple kicks.

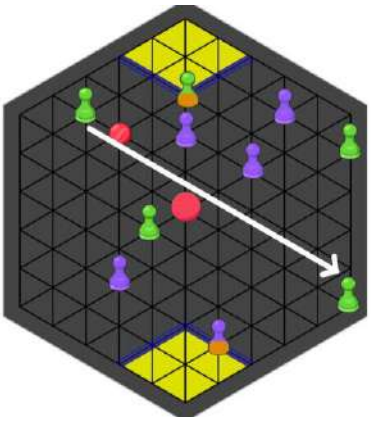


3) Result.

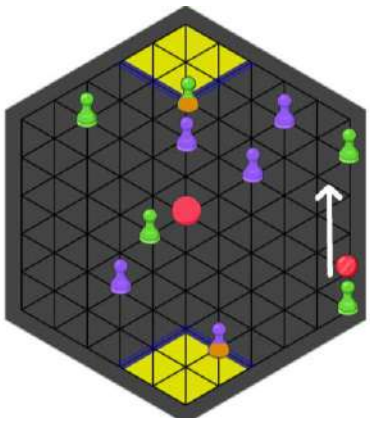


Green has a Field Player lined up with Purple's Goal. Green has no direct pass to that Player. Green executes a sequence to score.

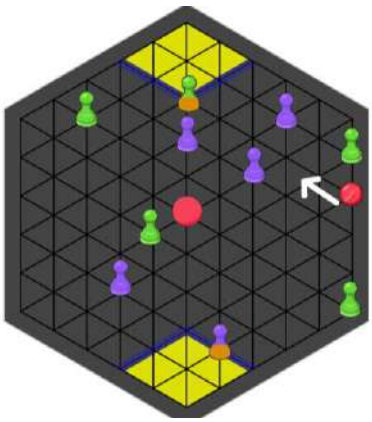
1) Green kicks.



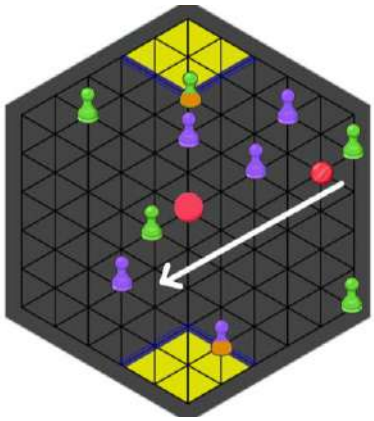
2) Green kicks.



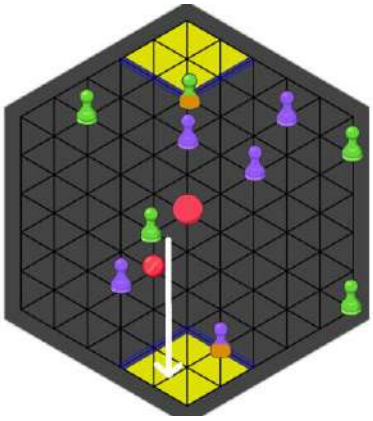
3) Green pivots.



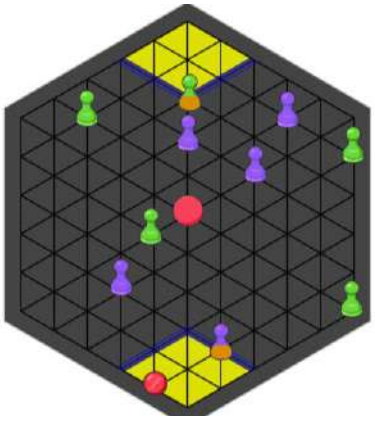
4) Green kicks.



5) Green kicks.



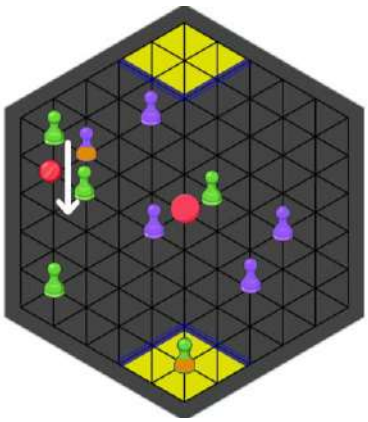
6) Green scores!



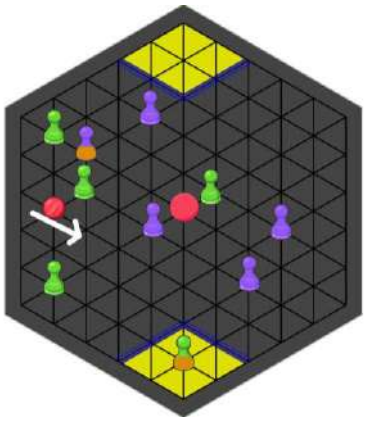
Advanced Possession Example

Purple's Goalie ran into the Field to block a short scoring sequence.
Goalies block pivots from opponent Players. Green finds a longer sequence to score.

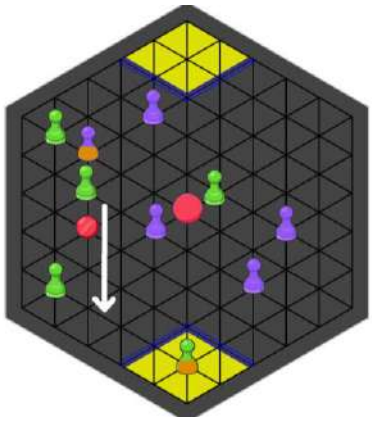
1) Green kicks.



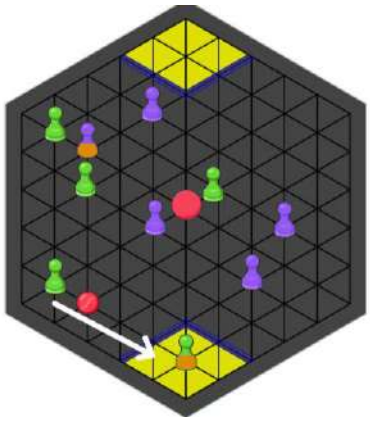
2) Green pivots.



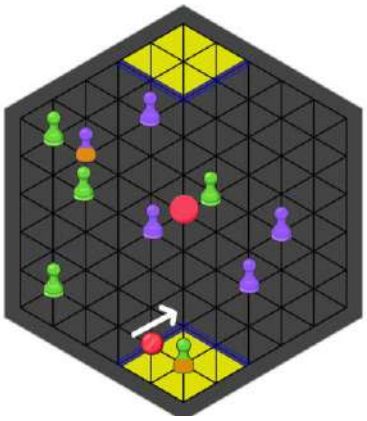
3) Green kicks.



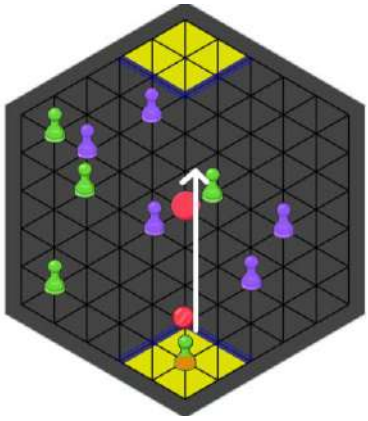
4) Green kicks to their Goal Line.



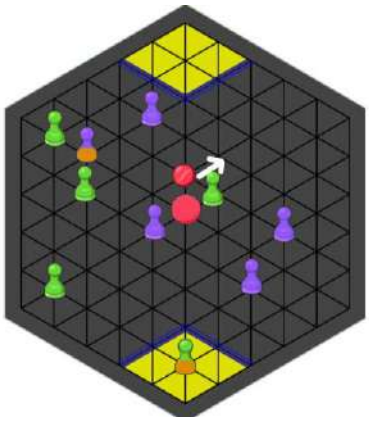
5) Green pivots.



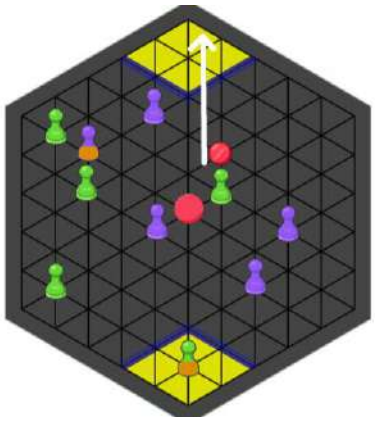
6) Goalies cannot score. Green kicks.



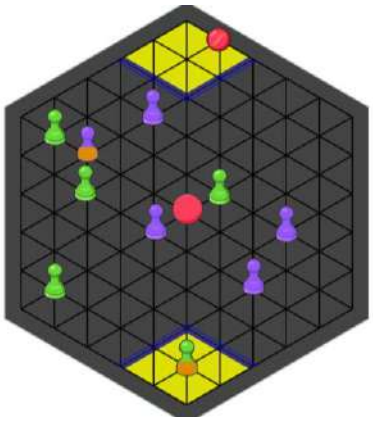
7) Green pivots.



8) Green kicks.



9) Green scores!

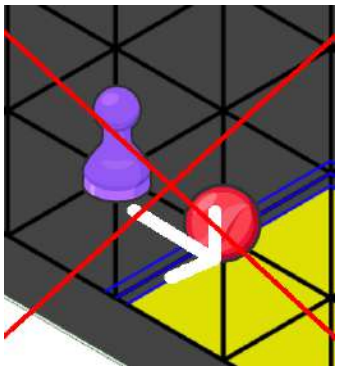


Regular Turn Phase 2: After Not Scoring: Run

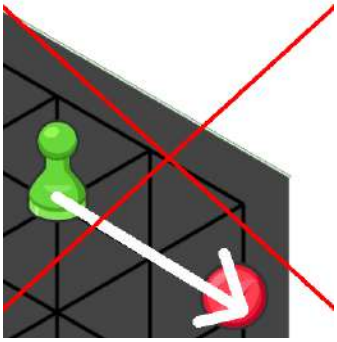
- If you did not score in Possession, your turn advances to the Run Phase.
- Move one of your Players in a straight line at least 1 spot.
    - Lava and other Players block running movement.
    - A running Field Player cannot move into a Goal Line.
    - Only your Goalie can move into your Goal Line and Goal.
    - If a running Player moves into the Ball, the Ball moves 1 spot ahead.
        - The Ball keeps moving forward with each spot the Player runs.
        - The Player must stop their run early if moving 1 more spot would push the Ball into a Player, off the board, or into their own goal.
- If you scored in Possession, proceed to the Celebration Phase.
    - If you did not score, instead proceed to the Ball Stuck Check Phase.

Invalid Run Examples

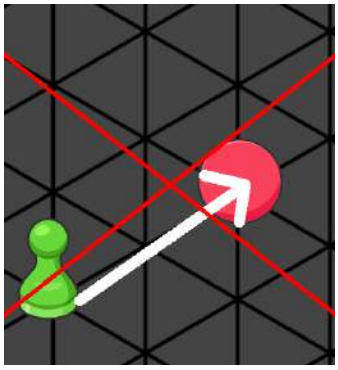
Field Players cannot run into a Goal Line.
Goalies cannot push the Ball into their own Goal.
Players cannot move into the opponent's Goal Line.



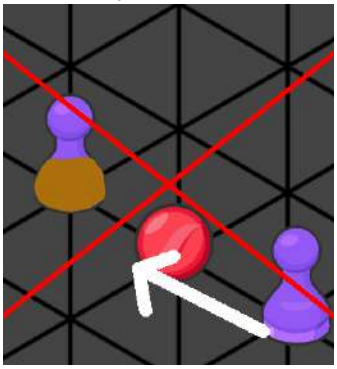
Players cannot push the Ball out of bounds.
The pushed Ball must have a spot to end on.
The spot must not have a Player on it.



The Ball can be pushed into or kicked through Lava.
Lava blocks Player runs.

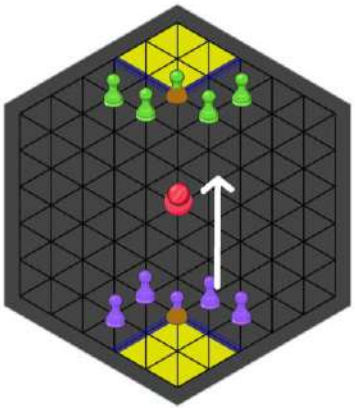


The Ball cannot end where a Player is.
Other Players block a running Player.

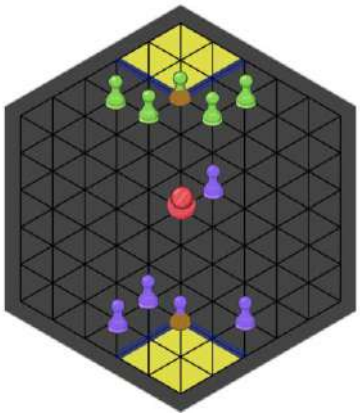


Run Examples

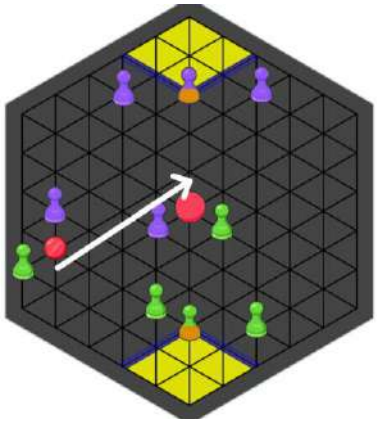
1) Purple runs on their first turn.



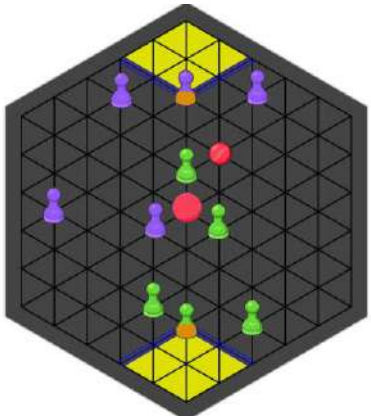
2) Purple will have Possession on their next turn.



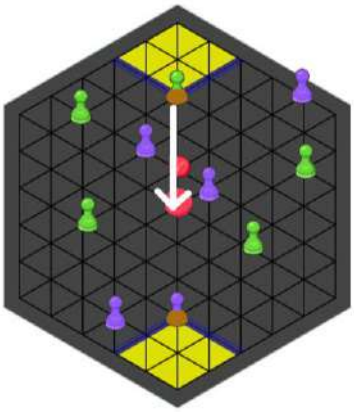
1) Green runs into the Ball.



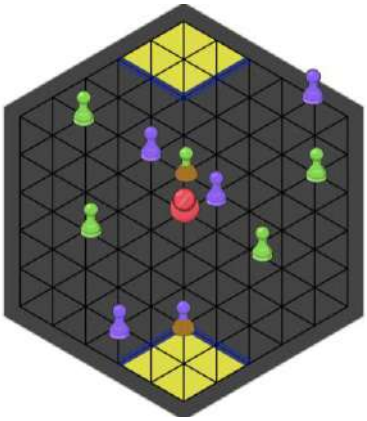
2) Green pushed the Ball forward.



1) Purple would be able to score.
Green's Goalie runs, disabling Purple's attack by blocking pivots between Players.



2) With Green's Goalie blocking the first pivot, Purple can no longer pivot, pivot, kick, kick, to score.

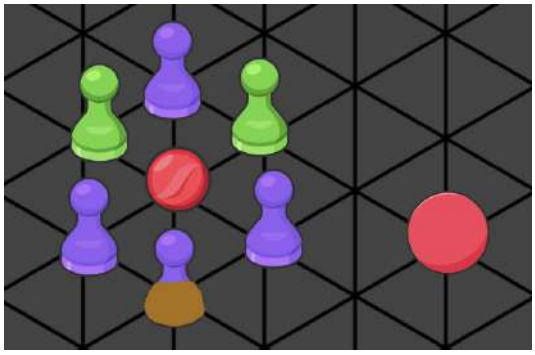


Regular Turn Phase 3: After Not Scoring: Ball Stuck Check

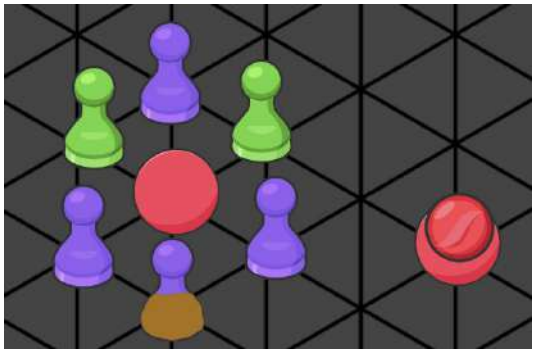
- If you did not score in Possession, check for the Ball being stuck after running.
- Most of the time, the Ball Stuck Check requires no action.
- After the Ball Stuck Check, your turn ends. Your opponent starts a Regular Turn.
- The Ball is stuck if there are no empty Field spots adjacent to the Ball.
- If the Ball is stuck:
    - Step 1: Remove the Ball.
    - Step 2: Add a Lava to the Field spot the Ball was stuck on, if that spot is not adjacent to Lava or a Goal Line.
    - Step 3: Place the Ball on the center Lava.

Ball Stuck Lava Placement Examples

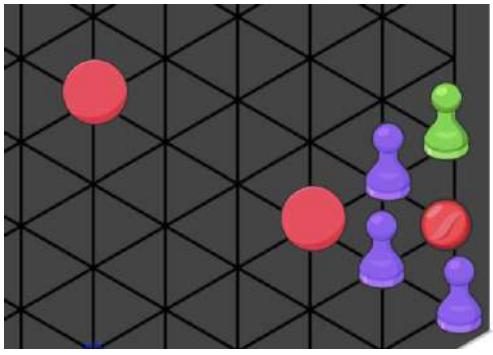
1) The Ball is stuck. Lava is placed on that spot.



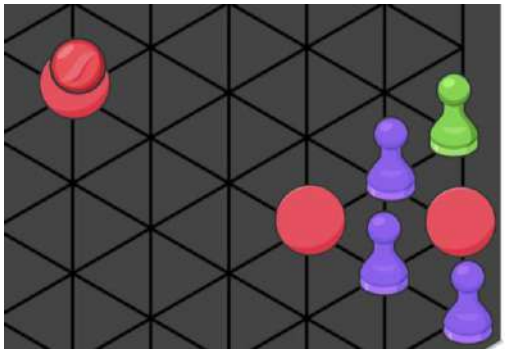
2) Result after the Ball Stuck Check.



1) The Ball is stuck. Lava is placed on that spot.



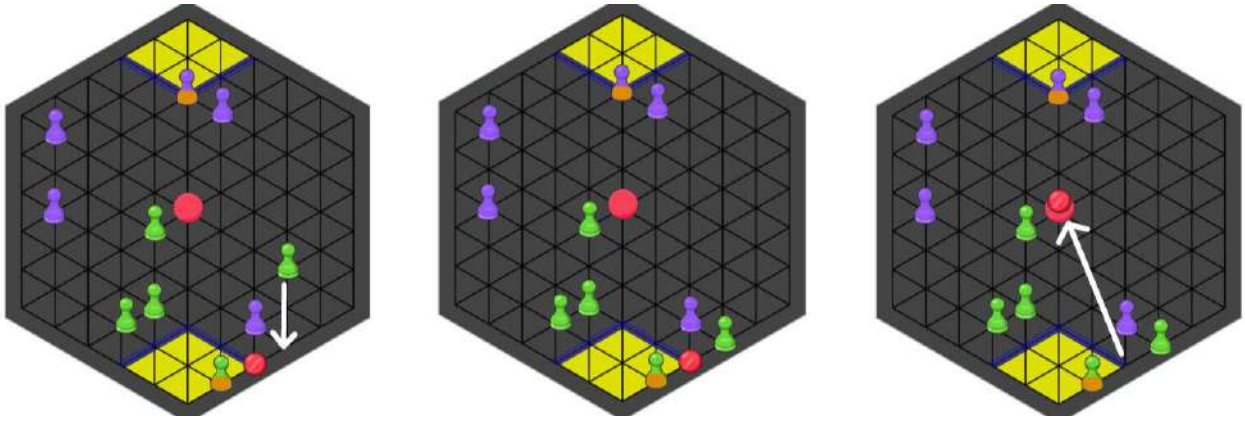
2) Result after the Ball Stuck Check.



Ball Stuck Check Examples

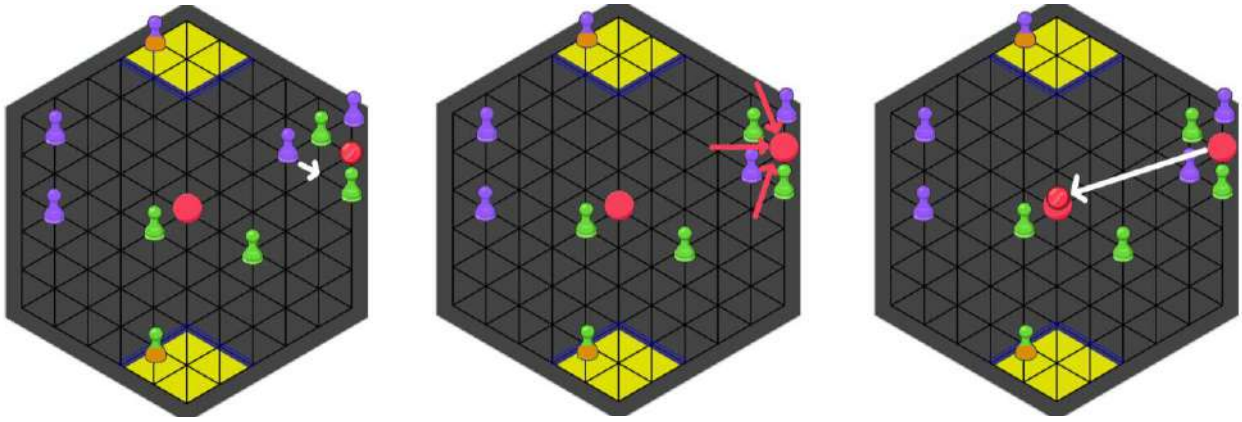
Green wants to escape Purple's threat. Making the Ball stuck resets the Ball to the center Lava.
No Lava is placed where the Ball was because that spot is adjacent to a Goal Line.
Green has a Player ready at the center, forcing Purple to defend on their next turn.

1) Green runs. *2) The Ball is stuck.* *3) No Lava was placed. The Ball resets.*



Purple wants to reset the Ball. Purple runs to make the Ball stuck.
Lava is placed which hampers further attacks from that area of the Field.

1) Purple runs, making the Ball stuck. *2) Lava is placed.* *3) The Ball resets.*



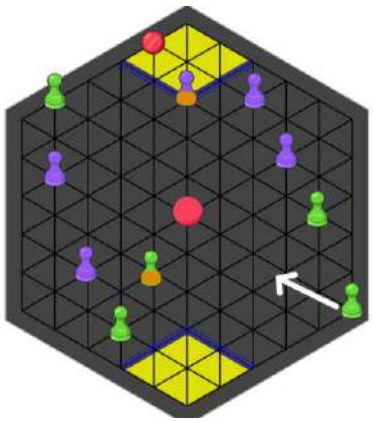
Regular Turn Phase 3: After Scoring: Celebration

- If you scored in Possession, you immediately celebrate.
    - Take 2 run actions (like in Regular Turn Phase 2) with any of your Players.
    - Reset your Goalie to any spot on your Goal Line.
- After Celebration, your turn ends. Your opponent starts a Goal Reaction Turn.

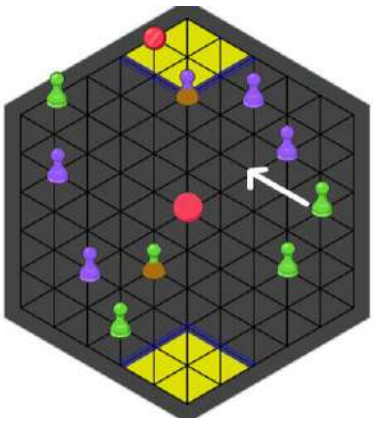
Celebration Example

In the Celebration Phase, Green takes 2 runs. After the extra run, compared to the single run in Phase 2: After Not Scoring, Green's Goalie resets.

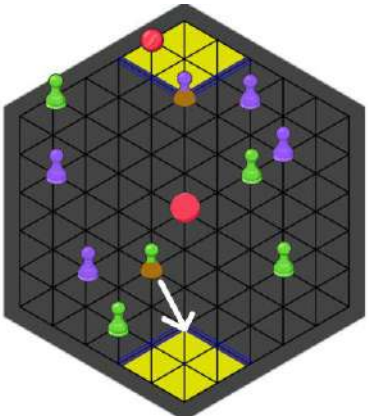
1) Green scored in Possession. Green runs.



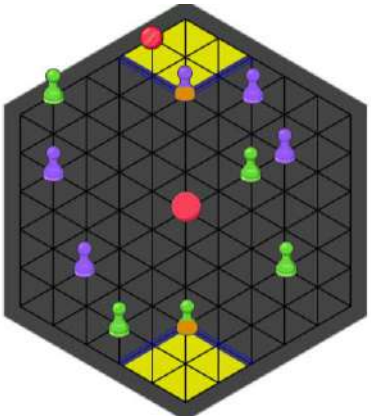
2) Green runs again.



3) Green's Goalie resets.



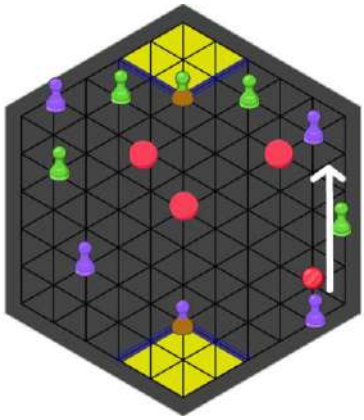
4) Result.



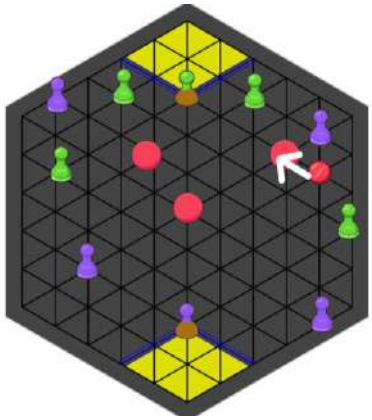
Full Regular Turn Example

Purple scores in Possession. Purple runs twice in Celebration. Purple's Goalie is already on the Goal Line, so in the Goalie reset step of Celebration, Purple can reset their Goalie to the same spot.

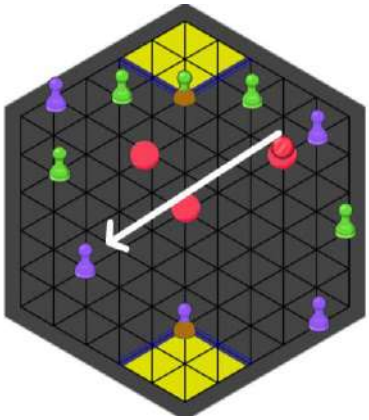
1) Purple kicks.



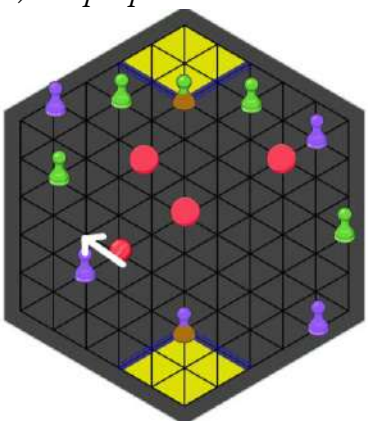
2) Purple pivots.



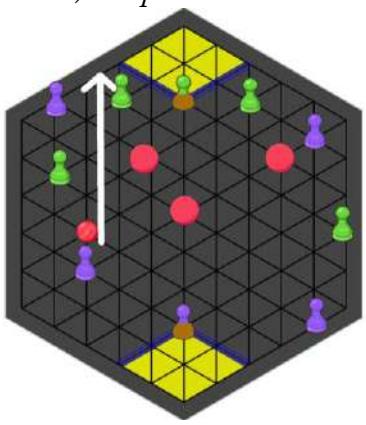
3) Purple kicks.



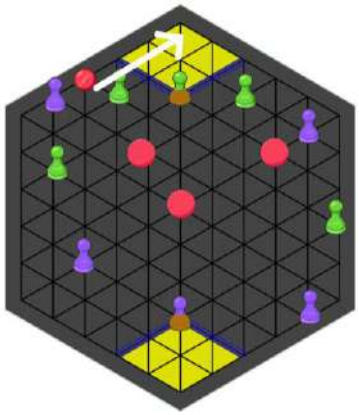
4) Purple pivots.



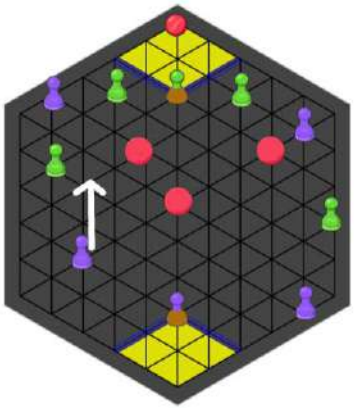
5) Purple kicks.



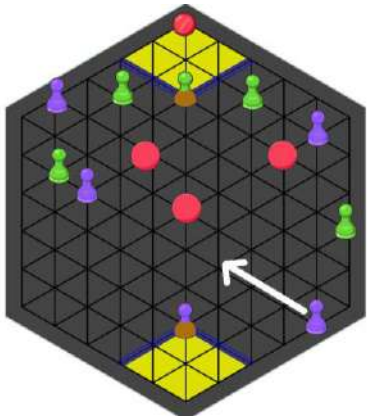
6) Purple kicks.



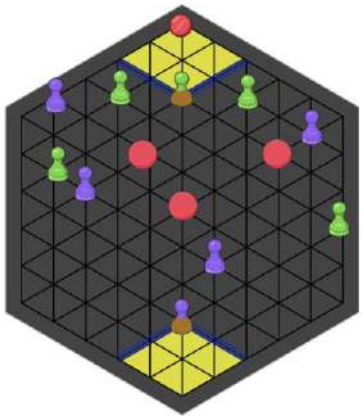
7) Purple scores, then runs.



8) 2nd Celebration run.



9) Purple's Goalie resets on the Goal Line.

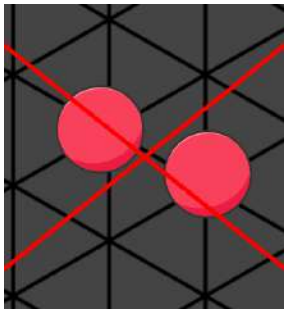


Goal Reaction Turn (All Phases)

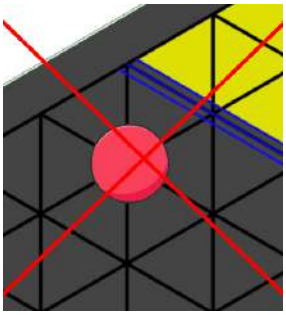
- You start a Goal Reaction Turn after your opponent ends their turn with Celebration.
- Phase 1: Reset Goalie Position
    - Move your Goalie to any spot on your Goal Line.
    - Optionally, place the Ball adjacent to your Goalie and outside of your Goal.
        - You can place the Ball where a Player is, because the Ball will move to its own spot in Phase 4: Kick Off.
- Phase 2: Defensive Runs
    - Take 2 Run actions (like in Regular Turn Phase 2) with any combination of your Field Players.
- Phase 3: Volcanic Eruption
    - Place 1 Lava to an empty Field spot.
    - Lava cannot be placed adjacent to Lava or a Goal Line.
- Phase 4: Kick Off
    - Optionally, move your Goalie anywhere on your Goal Line.
    - Place the Ball adjacent to your Goalie and outside of your Goal.
        - You can place the Ball where a Player is, because the Ball will move to its own spot.
    - Take a kick action with your Goalie, remembering:
        - The Ball must move at least 1 spot to a spot with no Player.
        - **Goalies cannot score.**
    - After the Kick Off, your opponent takes a Regular Turn.

Lava Examples

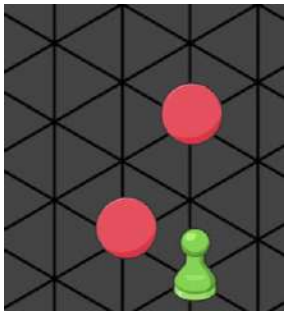
Lava cannot be placed next to Lava.



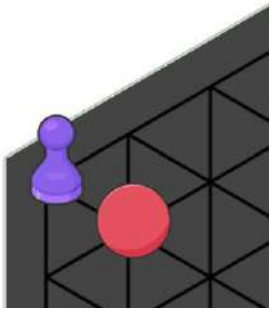
Lava cannot be placed next to a Goal Line.



Lava must be placed to an empty spot.



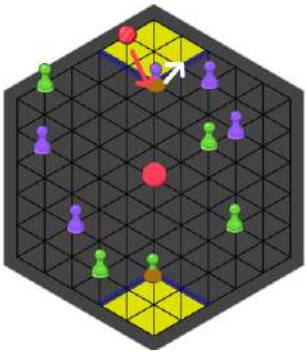
Lava placement can block potential runs.



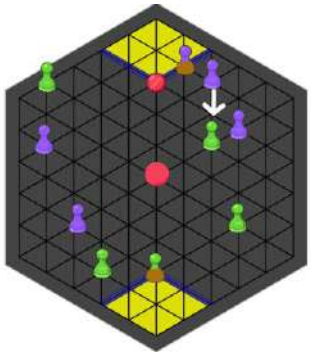
Goal Reaction Turn Examples

After Green scored and celebrated, Purple takes a Goal Reaction Turn.

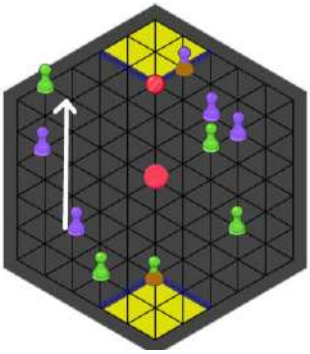
1) Purple repositions Goalie and Ball.



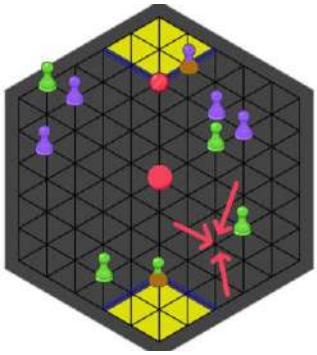
2) Purple runs.



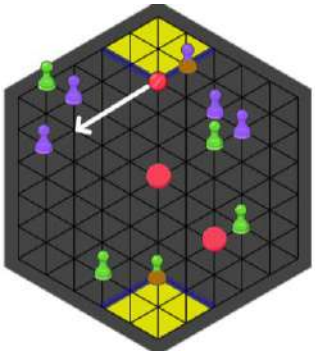
3) Purple runs.



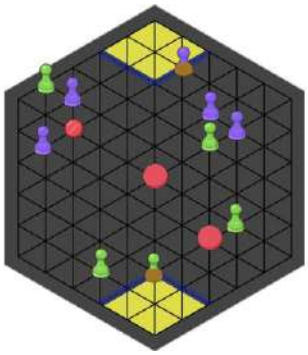
4) Purple places a Lava.



5) Purple's Goalie does their Kick Off.

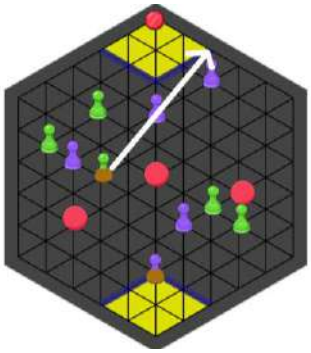


6) Result.

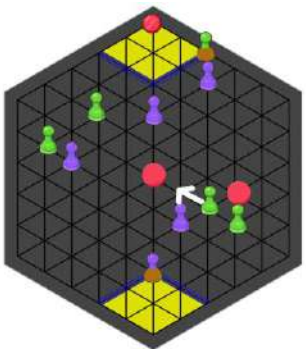


After Purple scored and celebrated, Green takes a Goal Reaction Turn.

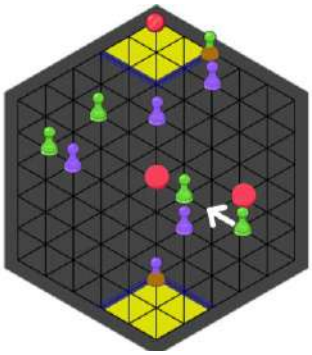
1) Green repositions their Goalie.



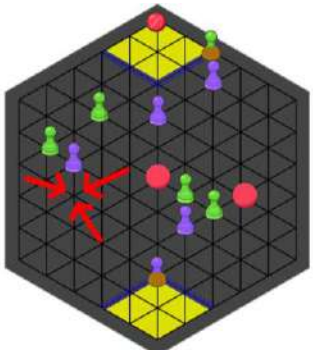
2) Green runs.



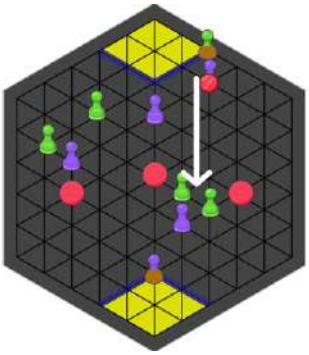
3) Greens runs.



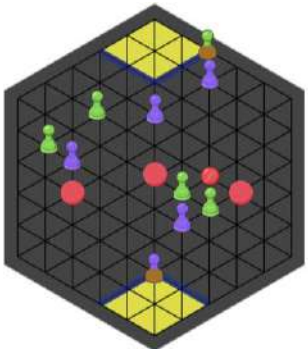
4) Green places a Lava.



5) Green places the Ball and Kicks Off.



6) Result.

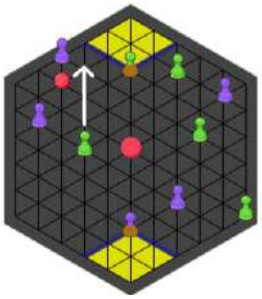


Defensive Strategic Concept: Interception

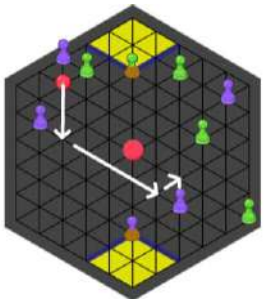
When your opponent has the ball, it is unlikely the ball will end next to one of your Players. To take Possession, take your turns positioning your Players in your Run Phase until you can run a Player through the ball, taking it away from your opponent.

1) Green runs, threatening to take Possession.
2) Purple uses their Possession Phase to move the ball away from Green's Player.
3) Purple runs in their Run Phase. Purple's Player is next to the Lava, which is where the Ball would be if Green's Field Player in the bottom right corner ran as far as possible towards the Ball.
4) Green runs just enough to intercept the Ball, securing a Possession Phase next turn and denying Purple a Possession Phase on their next turn.
5) Purple is unable to intercept and is now on defense.

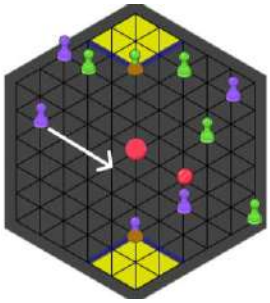
1



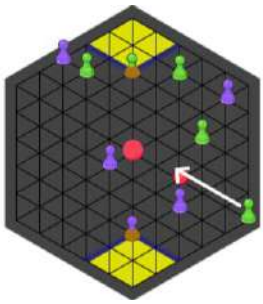
2



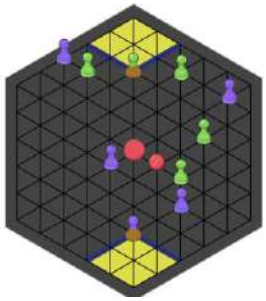
3



4

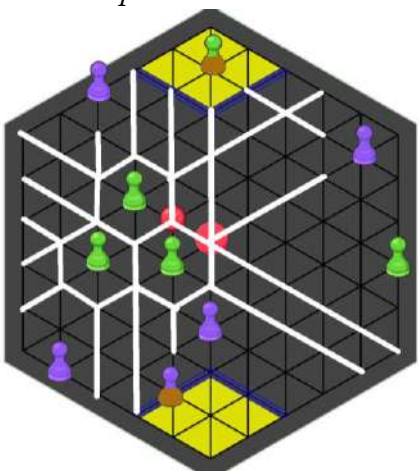


5



Offensive Strategic Concept: Tight Formations

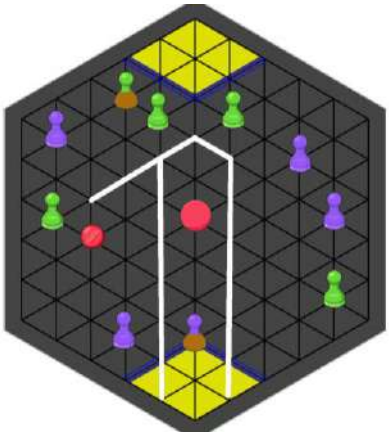
Positioning your Players close and on separate lines increases possibilities to move the Ball in Possession. The example picture shows all possible lines Green can move the Ball on.



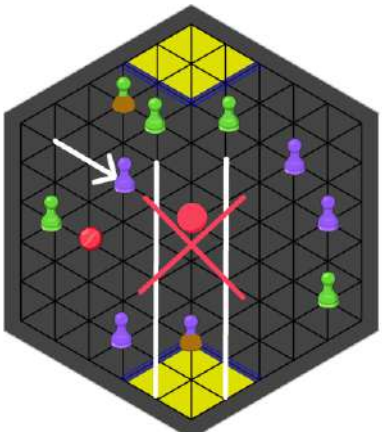
Defensive Strategic Concept: Blocking Passing Lines

When your opponent has the Ball, blocking their opportunities to pass the Ball between Players limits their options in Possession, increasing your opportunity to intercept and take Possession.

1) Lines show Green's potential scoring. Purple has no interception opportunity. control.



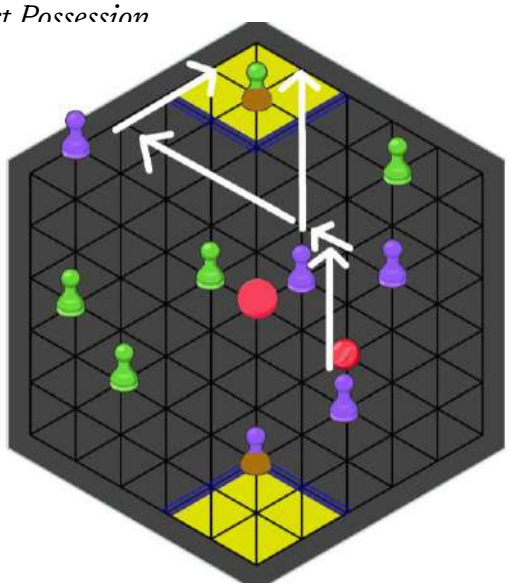
2) Purple blocks the line connecting Green's players, restricting Green's



Offensive Strategic Concept: Attacking From 2 Directions

Your opponent will try to block your lines of attack. Force a goal by attacking simultaneously from 2 directions with different players.

Lines show 2 directions Purple can score from. Green can only block 1 of them in their Run Phase. Purple can score on their next Possession



Expert Options

- You can play with any of these Expert Options if your opponent agrees.
    - _ Goals To Win: You win at a higher number of goals scored.
        - Why: You want a longer game. Default setting: 5.
    - Goalie Kick Interrupt: Your Goalie kicking ends your Posssesion Phase.
        - Why: You want explosive offense to be more difficult.
    - Double Lava: When you score a goal, your opponent places 2 Lava.
        - Why: You want more challenging positions.
    - Sand Timer: Start the game with a 60 second sand timer or equivalent timing device, with distinctive appearance on each side: "black" for recharging and "red" for draining. Start each turn by flipping your sand timer to black down, red up. When you end your turn, flip your timer back to show black up. If your sand runs out with red up, your opponent moves the ball in a straight line, as if they were taking a kick action with their Goalie (they cannot score), then reset all sand timers, then your opponent starts their turn.
        - Why: Time is a resource. Calculating positions quickly is a skill.
- Recommendations:
    - Teaching an inexperienced opponent:
        - You: Goalie Kick Interrupt.
        - Your opponent: No Expert Options.
    - Regular play:
        - You and your opponent: Goalie Kick Interrupt.
    - Tournament play:
        - You and your opponent: 5 Goals, Goalie Kick Interrupts, Sand Timer.
- Fireball goals
- Unpredictable Effort: posession rolls a die, number of moves maxed to the die value

Links

How to Play: https://youtu.be/XiFxWRTfY6g

Rules PDF: https://linktr.ee/lavaball

More Games: https://linktr.ee/playlines

Email: playlines@proton.me

BGG: https://boardgamegeek.com/user/quantumpotato